Changes in Railway confirmed ticket cancellation rules

Indian Railways has introduced several changes to its rules regarding the cancellation of confirmed tickets. The previous timeframes for cancelling tickets, 48, 12, and 4 hours before train departure, have been revised to 72, 24, and 8 hours, respectively. This modification has been implemented to align with the process of preparing reservation charts, which are now generated between 9 and 18 hours before departure. This new railway rule will directly benefit passengers currently on the waiting list. If a person cancels a confirmed ticket—or has it cancelled—between 24 and 72 hours in advance, 25% of the fare will be deducted. If cancelled between 8 and 24 hours in advance, a 50% deduction will apply; for cancellations made less than 8 hours prior, no refund will be issued. Under the new provisions, passengers will now be able to upgrade their travel class up to 30 minutes prior to departure, a change that was previously possible only before the reservation charts were prepared. Ashwini Vaishnaw, the Minister for Railways, Information & Broadcasting, and Electronics & Information Technology, stated that the objective behind these changes is to ensure that tickets are secured by genuine passengers. For this purpose, approximately 30 million suspicious accounts have also been closed. The Railway Minister further added that, henceforth, counter tickets can be cancelled at any railway station across the country.



Promoting Tribal Products on E-Commerce Platforms



In an effort to empower tribal artisans and promote indigenous products, the Department of Posts has entered into an agreement with the Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India (TRIFED), an organisation operating under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs. Under the terms of this agreement, the Department of Posts will provide end-to-end logistics solutions for all e-commerce orders placed through TRIFED's online channels. This initiative will significantly strengthen market access for tribal artisans and entrepreneurs. This partnership is poised to boost tribal livelihoods and foster growth within the digital economy, while simultaneously contributing to an increase in the income of tribal communities.

Creating History by Producing 50 Million Tonnes of Iron Ore

India's largest iron ore producer and 'Navratna' CPSE, NMDC Limited, has created history by becoming the country's first mining company to produce 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single financial year. Since 2015, production has increased by approximately two-thirds, rising from 30 million tonnes to 50 million tonnes. Of this growth, nearly one-fifth of the current capacity has been added within just the last four years. India is steadily advancing toward its goal of increasing its steel manufacturing capacity to 300 million tonnes by 2030.

